British India (1912-1947): Nationalist Movements and Road to Partition

From the First World War to the Government of India Act of 1919

- PARTITION OF BENGAL REVERSED (1911)
- CAPITAL OF THE *RAJ* IS MOVED TO DELHI
- BENGAL LOSES ITS PREEMINENCE IN THE SUBCONTINENT; AS CURZON HAD ORIGINALLY HOPED
- BENGALI MUSLIMS ARE UNHAPPY AT THE LOSS THEIR MAJORITY PROVINCE; POLITICAL MOBILIZATION REMAINS; COMMUNAL ISSUES REMAIN UNRESOLVED
- 1909: SEPARATE ELECTORATES ARE CREATED FOR HINDUS, MUSLIMS AND OTHER RELIGIOUS/CATEGORIZED COMMUNITIES

From the First World War to the Government of India Act of 1919

- AUGUST 1914: OUTBREAK OF THE FIRST WORLD WAR
- CONGRESS AND THE LEAGUE PLEDGE LOYALTY AND COLLABORATION IN RETURN FOR VAGUE PROMISES OF 'SELF-RULE'

- OVER A £ 1 BILLION POUNDS STERLING ADDITIONALLY EXTRACTED FROM THE SUBCONTINENT AS A 'GIFT'
- FOOD AND GRAIN FORCIBLY SEIZED FROM FARMERS TO FEED BRITISH, MERCENARY AND OTHER EMPIRE-ALLIED FORCES
- FAMINE-LIKE CONDITIONS RETURN TO THE SUBCONTINENT

From the First World War to the Government of India Act of 1919

- 1912: BENGAL REVOLUTIONARIES BOMB VICEROY DURING HIS INAUGURAL ENTRY TO DELHI
- BENGAL *NEW ERA* GROUPS, SIKH 'GHADAR' ('REBELLION' OR 'MUTINY') AND PAN-ISLAMIST REVOLUTIONARIES JOIN HANDS WITH THE GERMAN AND OTTOMAN EMPIRES IN A BID OVERTHROW THE *RAJ*
- A PROVISIONAL GOVERNMENT IS FORMED IN KABUL
- FEBRUARY 21, 1915: PLANNED 1857-STYLE UPRISING WITH GERMAN ASSISTANCE FAILS
- RASH BEHARI BOSE, PRINCIPAL MASTERMIND OF 1912 AND 1915 ESCAPES TO IMPERIAL JAPAN

From the First World War to the Government of India Act of 1919

- AT THE END OF THE FIRST WORLD WAR; THE BRITISH EMPIRE IS VICTORIOUS – BUT ONLY JUST, AND INTENT ON REESTABLISHING ITS SUPREMACY AS ONE OF THE LEADING WORLD POWERS

- THE TRIUMPH OF THE RUSSIAN REVOLUTION INTRODUCES A DIMENSION IN WORLD-POLITICS; THE FIRST DECLARED SOCIALIST WORKERS' STATE
  - NO SELF-RULE WILL BE GIVEN BY THE *RAJ*
  - CONGRESS AND THE LEAGUE DISCREDITED

- *RAJ* HOWEVER OFFERS CONCESSIONS IN THE FORM OF THE GOVERNMENT OF INDIA ACT OF 1919

Chittaranjan Das came of age during the Bengal/Indian Renaissance. Poet, writer and lawyer, he became involved in anti-colonial politics in 1910 when he represented New Era defendants. Tremendously popular mass Indian leader, known affectionately as 'Deshbandhu' ('Friend of the Country') and the 'uncrowned king' of Bengal, held the unconditional respect and trust of Hindu and Muslim alike. His death in 1925 was a shattering blow for inter-religious harmony in Bengal and the subcontinent.



Deshbandhu Chittaranjan Das (1870 – 1925)

From the First World War to the Government of India Act of 1919

- UNDER THE ACT:
- ELECTIONS WILL BE ALLOWED TO COLONIAL PROVINCIAL LEGISLATURES
- LIMITED FRANCHISE
- SYSTEM OF 'DYARCHY'; *RAJ* PROVINCIAL GOVERNORS WILL SHARE MINOR PORTFOLIOS
- SUBCONTINENTAL PEOPLES WILL ALSO BE ALLOWED TO RUN FOR MUNICIPAL ELECTIONS
- CHITTARANJAN DAS BECOMES THE MAYOR OF CALCUTTA; COMMITTED TO EXPANDING MUSLIM PARTICIPATION IN ALL SPHERES OF BENGALI LIFE
- APPOINTS H.S. SUHRAWARDY AS DEPUTY MAJOR AND STARTING HIS CAREER IN POLITICS
- APPOINTS 27 YEAR OLD SUBHAS CHANDRA BOSE AS CHIEF EXECUTIVE OFFICER

A brilliant student of Philosophy at Cambridge University, Subhas Chandra Bose was the first Indian to resign voluntarily from the formidable *Raj* bureaucracy – the so-called 'British Indian Civil Service' – in 1921.

Imprisoned eleven times by the *Raj* for anti-colonial activities and as early as the 1930s was secretly acknowledged by London as the one "implacable foe of British rule" in the subcontinent.



Subhas Chandra Bose (circa. 1930s)

From the failure of Satyagraha-Khilafat to the start of the Second World War

- THE LEGEND OF MOHANDAS KARAMCHAND GANDHI, THE 'GREAT-SOULED' ONE OR THE *MAHATMA* TO HIS FOLLOWERS AND ADMIRERS
- FROM THE GUJARAT REGION
- BRIEF CAREER IN LAW
- AWAKENED TO INJUSTICE IN BRITISH OCCUPIED SOUTHERN AFRICA
- FASHIONS THE TACTIC OF 'SATYAGRAHA' OR 'STRUGGLE IN TRUTH' AS A DISOBEDIENCE METHOD
- RETURNS TO THE SUBCONTINENT AFTER THE START OF THE FIRST WORLD WAR AND IS GIVEN THE LEADERSHIP POSITION OF CONGRESS IN 1920 AFTER ITS FAILURES TO FORCE CONCESSIONS FROM THE *RAJ*

From the failure of Satyagraha-Khilafat to the start of the Second World War

- GANDHI LEADS THREE MOVEMENTS; SATYAGRAHA-KHILAFAT (1921-1922), THE SALT TAX SATYAGRAHA (1930) AND THE QUIT INDIA MOVEMENT OF 1942
- COMBINES 'SELF-SUFFERING' WITH STRICT NON-VIOLENT CIVIL DISOBEDIENCE
- DURING 1946-1947 TRIES TO MITIGATE COMMUNAL RIOTS
- ASSASSINATED BY A HINDU EXTREMIST IN 1948

From the failure of Satyagraha-Khilafat to the start of the Second World War

- THE REALITY IS MORE COMPLEX THAN THE LEGEND;
- GANDHI CONSTRUCTS HIS WORLDVIEW IN LATE-19TH CENTURY ENGLAND AND IMBIBES HIS INITIAL UNDERSTANDING OF HINDUISM FROM FRINGE(MARGINAL) ELEMENTS IN LONDON
- ALSO ABSORBS IDEAS FROM THE CULT OF THEOSOPHY
- THE END RESULT IS A MIXTURE OF HINDUISM AND MISSIONARY CHRISTIANITY
- WANTS TO ACHIEVE *MOKSHA* (SPIRITUAL PERFECTION) FOR HIMSELF AND TO ESTABLISH A *RAM RAJYA* ('KINGDOM OF LORD RAMA') IN THE SUBCONTINENT
- HIS SELF-INVESTED MISSIONARY OBJECTIVE MEANS HIS VIEW OF THE BRITISH EMPIRE IS AT ODDS WITH *SWARAJ*

From the failure of Satyagraha-Khilafat to the start of the Second World War

- HIS WISH IS NOT TO FORCE THE BRITISH EMPIRE FROM THE SUBCONTINENT BUT TO FORGE A FRIENDSHIP FOR HIS WORLDLY GOALS
- TO ACHIEVE THIS FRIENDSHIP HE WISHES TO ONLY PUT PRESSURE ON THE *RAJ* (THE BRITISH MAY LEAVE ON THEIR OWN IF THEY WISH)
- IN 1921 GANDHI ADMITS TO FRENCH PHILOSOPHER PAUL ANTOINE RICHARD THAT INDEPENDENCE FOR THE SUBCONTINENT IS *NOT* AS IMPORTANT FOR HIM AS HIS GLOBAL MISSIONARY OBJECTIVE
- IN PRACTICAL TERMS THERE ARE ALSO PROBLEMS; IN SOUTHERN AFRICA, GANDHI HAD BOTH MADE HORRIBLE RACIST STATEMENTS AGAINST INDIGENOUS PEOPLES AND SUPPORTED THE BRUTAL BRITISH SUPPRESSION OF AFRICAN ANTI-COLONIAL UPRISINGS

From the failure of Satyagraha-Khilafat to the start of the Second World War

- **DURING THE FIRST WORLD WAR; GANDHI *VOLUNTEERS* TO RAISE MERCENARY RECRUITS TO FIGHT FOR THE *RAJ* – A DIRECTION CONTRADICTION OF HIS CLAIM TO BE A STRICT PACIFIST**
- **IN CONJUNCTION WITH THIS GANDHI IS TOTALLY OPPOSED TO THE ARMED REVOLUTIONARY TRADITION, ITS OBJECTIVES AND MILITANT FREEDOM FIGHTERS**

- **GANDHI ALSO HAS A PRACTICE OF CLAIMING LEADERSHIP IN ONGOING STRUGGLES OR CAMPAIGNS – CREATING THE *PERCEPTION* HE HAD BEEN THE ORIGINATOR OF THE AGITATIONS – AND ABANDONING ANY IN WHICH HE CANNOT OBTAIN AN ADVANTAGE FOR HIMSELF – HISTORIAN JUDITH BROWN**

From the failure of Satyagraha-Khilafat to the start of the Second World War

- GANDHI ALSO BELIEVES THAT HIS ENGAGEMENT WITH THE 'TRUTH' HAS PLACED HIM ABOVE THE REALITIES OF POLITICS AND BEYOND RESPONSIBILITY FOR HIS WORDS OR ACTIONS
- GANDHI IS HONEST ABOUT HIS RELIGIOUS OUTLOOK BUT USES IT TO INVOKE SUPPORT; BUT AT THE COST OF ALIENATING MINORITIES AND LOWER-CASTE HINDUS
- HE ALSO WILLFULLY OBSTRUCTS THOSE, LIKE CHITTARANJAN DAS AND LATER SUBHAS CHANDRA BOSE WHO WERE TRYING TO BUILD BRIDGES ACROSS THE RELIGIOUS DIVIDE
- GANDHI'S RELIGIOUS OUTLOOK IS ALSO HEAVILY INFLUENCED BY HIS POWERFUL FINANCIERS, WHO ARE OPENLY COMMUNAL AS A GROUP

Gandhi, who ascended to the supreme leadership of Congress after 1920 was bitterly opposed to the armed revolutionary tradition and saw in them his principal and hated rivals.

By the 1930s, Subhas Chandra Bose was the one mass leader in the subcontinent who envisioned an armed revolution to completely kick out the *Raj*.



Karamchand Gandhi(left) with Subhas Chandra Bose(right) during a brief period of 'truce', Haripura Congress Session, 1938

From the failure of Satyagraha-Khilafat to the start of the Second World War

- REALIZING THAT HE CANNOT BRING MUSLIMS INTO A JOINT AGITATION OF PRESSURE AGAINST THE *RAJ* WITHOUT A SECULAR MANTLE, GANDHI PROMISES TO SAVE THE OTTOMAN EMPEROR OR 'SULTAN' WHO ALSO CLAIMED TO BE THE CALIPH OF ISLAM
- IN THE PROCESS GANDHI JOINS HANDS WITH COMMUNAL MUSLIMS
- THE ARBITRARY CALLING OFF OF THE MOVEMENT AFTER THE REDEMPTIVE ACTS OF FARMERS AT CHAURI-CHAURA (UNITED PROVINCES) WORSENS THE RELIGIOUS AND POLITICAL SITUATION ACROSS THE SUBCONTINENT
- ORDINARY PEOPLE ARE SO ANGRY THAT THERE IS NO REACTION WHEN GANDHI IS IMPRISONED FOR A FEW MONTHS
- *DESHBANDHU* CHITTARANJAN DAS DECIDES TO TAKE ON THE ISSUES DIVIDING HINDU FROM MUSLIM FIRST IN BENGAL AND THEN PROPOSE IT AS A MODEL FOR THE SUBCONTINENT



The final departure of Mehmed VI, last Sultan of the Ottoman Empire

From the failure of Satyagraha-Khilafat to the start of the Second World War

- BENGAL PACT OF 1923:
- INSTITUTIONAL SEATING AND DISTRIBUTION OF JOBS WILL BE BASED ON THE POPULATION BREAKDOWN OF BENGAL BY RELIGION
- 60% OF SEATS WILL BE RESERVED FOR MUSLIMS AND 40% FOR HINDUS
- FOR OFFICIAL JOB APPOINTMENTS; 55% OF POSITIONS WILL BE RESERVED FOR MUSLIMS BUT UNTIL THEY REACH THE 55% MARK 80% OF ALL NEW POSITIONS WILL BE GIVEN TO MUSLIMS
- NO ONE WILL BE ALLOWED TO PLAY MUSIC IN FRONT OF MOSQUES DURING PRAYER TIMES & COW SLAUGHTER WILL ONLY BE ALLOWED FOR THE ISLAMIC FEAST OF THE SACRIFICE
- ALL THE CLAUSES WILL BE SUPERVISED BY JOINT BOARDS AT ALL LEVELS

From the failure of Satyagraha-Khilafat to the start of the Second World War

- WHEN THE PACT IS PUT FORWARD AT THE KAKINADA SESSION OF CONGRESS GANDHI AND HIS ALLIES HAVE IT STRUCK DOWN
- IN BENGAL HOWEVER THE PACT IS UPHELD

- JUNE 1925: THE UNEXPECTED AND TRAGIC PASSING OF THE *DESHBANDHU* LEAVES A TREMENDOUS VOID

- SUBHAS CHANDRA BOSE IS NOT RELEASED FROM ARBITRARY IMPRISONMENT BY THE *RAJ* FOR TWO YEARS UNDER HORRIFIC CONDITIONS UNTIL 1927

- CONGRESS, ALREADY UNPOPULAR WITH BENGALI MUSLIMS FOR 1922 BECOMES EVEN MORE SUSPECT WITH THE OPPOSITION TO THE BENGAL TENANCY ACT OF 1928

From the failure of Satyagraha-Khilafat to the start of the Second World War

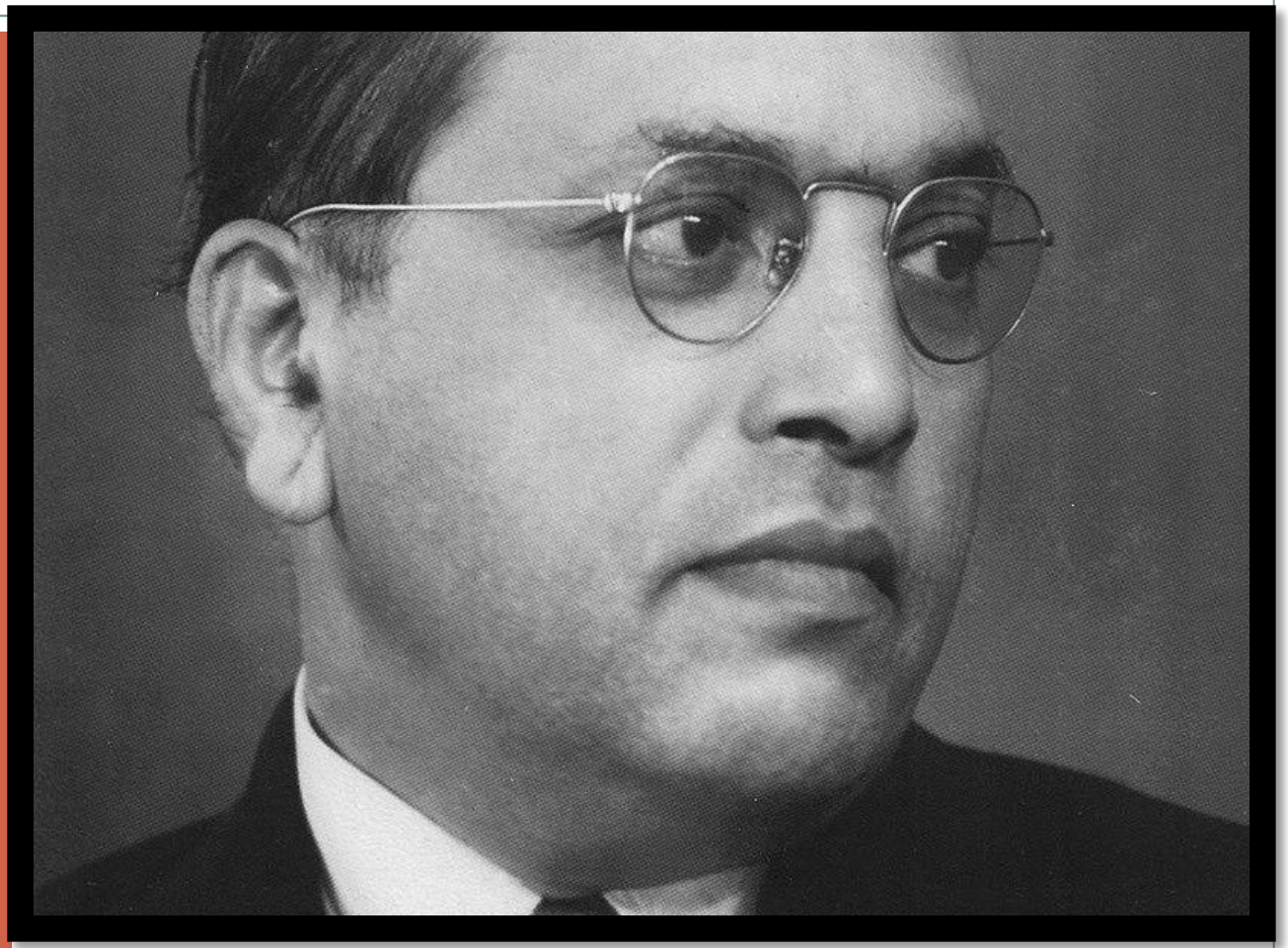
- EARLY 20TH CENTURY MUSLIM POLITICAL MOBILIZATION RUNS PARALLEL TO AWAKENING OF *DALIT* ('BROKEN' OR 'OPPRESSED') MASS CONSCIOUSNESS
- THE COUNTER-REACTION IS THE CREATION OF ORGANIZATIONS SUCH AS THE *HINDU MAHASABHA* ('HINDU GENERAL ASSEMBLY') AND *RASTRIYA SWAYAMSEVAK SANGH* ('NATIONAL VOLUNTEERS' ASSOCIATION')
- THESE EVENTUALLY TURN THEIR FOCUS AGAINST MUSLIM MOBILIZATION AS WELL
- BHIMRAO RAMJI AMBEDKAR IS THE LEADING FIGURE AMONGST THE *DALIT* LEADERSHIP WHO EXPOSES GANDHI'S ATTITUDES TOWARDS THE OPPRESSED LOWER CASTES

One of the foremost defenders of the *Dalit* (Oppressed Castes) community during his lifetime.

Bitterly opposed caste prejudice, single-handedly took on Karamchand Gandhi in the 1920s, 1930s & 1940s, who was forced to clarify his support the Caste System.

Ambedkar was pressured to sign the Poona Pact in 1932, a decision his regretted to the end of his life.

Converted to Buddhism before his death.



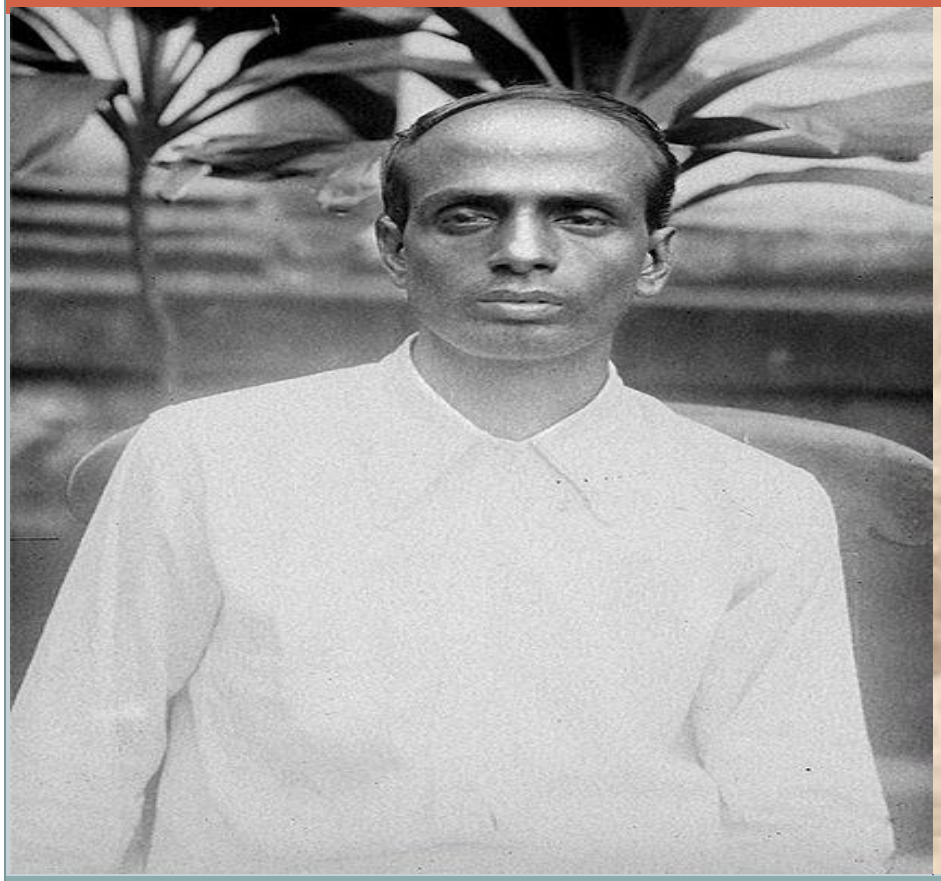
Dr. Bhimrao Ramji Ambedkar (1891 – 1956)

From the failure of Satyagraha-Khilafat to the start of the Second World War

- IN 1930 GANDHI LAUNCHES THE SALT MARCH SATYAGRAHA; IT IS CAREFULLY CHOREOGRAPHED AND PUBLICIZED – ITS OBJECTIVES EVEN LESS AMBITIOUS THEN IN 1921-1922 FOCUSING ON THE *RAJ* TAXATION ON SALT-MAKING BY COASTAL COMMUNITIES
- PARALLEL AGITATIONS ARE LAUNCHED
- A MORE DRAMATIC AND WORRYING ARMED UPRISING IS ATTEMPTED BY PRIMARILY BENGAL REVOLUTIONARIES IN THE PORT OF CHITTAGONG IN APRIL 1930
- WHILE LINKS TO THE PORT FROM THE REST OF THE *RAJ* ARE CUT OFF FOR A FEW DAYS, AN INCORRECT STRATEGY – GUERRILLAS FACING A REGULAR ARMY ON OPEN GROUND PROVES TRAGIC FOR THE FREEDOM FIGHTERS

Freedom fighters of the Chittagong Uprising 1930

Surya Sen



Pritilata Waddedar



From the failure of Satyagraha-Khilafat to the start of the Second World War

- DURING 1931-1932 THE *RAJ* INVITES LEADERS OF ALL PARTIES AND COLLECTIVE INTERESTS TO LONDON FOR A SERIES OF SO-CALLED *ROUND TABLE CONFERENCES*
- GANDHI, INSISTING ON REPRESENTING CONGRESS ALONE, IS COMPLETELY OUTMANEUVERED BY OTHER *RAJ* COLLABORATORS
- THE *RAJ* AT THE END ANNOUNCES THE 'MACDONALD AWARD' – AFTER THE BRITISH PRIME MINISTER JAMES MACDONALD – ALTHOUGH MORE COMMONLY KNOWN AS THE COMMUNAL AWARD

- IN BENGAL, IT REDUCES REPRESENTATION IN THE COLONIAL LEGISLATIVE ASSEMBLY FOR THE UPPER-CASTE HINDU MIDDLE-CLASSES

From the failure of Satyagraha-Khilafat to the start of the Second World War

- TO PARTICIPATE IN THE COLONIAL LEGISLATIVE NOW MEANS BEING A POWERLESS MINORITY
- CASTE ANGER – INSTEAD OF BEING DIRECTED AGAINST THE BRITISH – IS TARGETED AT THE PERCEIVED BENEFICIARIES OF THE AWARD; BENGALI MUSLIMS
- MANY CASTE BENGALI HINDUS NOW BEGIN TO TURN AWAY FROM THE NATIONALIST, ANTI-COLONIAL CAUSE
- BENGALI MUSLIM OPINION REGARDING THE AWARD IS VARIED BUT GENERALLY THEY WERE ALREADY MORE CONFIDENT OF HOLDING THEIR GROUND AND HAVING A FAIR SAY IN THE AFFAIRS OF BENGAL ALONGSIDE THEIR BENGALI HINDU BRETHREN BEFORE THE AWARD

From the failure of Satyagraha-Khilafat to the start of the Second World War

- IN THE EARLY 1930S AN UMBRELLA PARTY IS FORMED TO REPRESENT PRIMARILY NON-ELITE BENGALI MUSLIMS AND FARMERS;
- *KRISHAK PRAJA PARTY* ('PEASANTS AND TENANTS PARTY)
- IT IS AN UMBRELLA ORGANIZATION WITH FIGURES SUCH AS A.K. FAZLUL HUQ IN THE LEADERSHIP
- THE SO-CALLED GOVERNMENT OF INDIA ACT OF 1935 ALLOWS FOR FURTHER EXPANSION OF THE BENGALI MUSLIM FRANCHISE

From the failure of Satyagraha-Khilafat to the start of the Second World War

- SUBHAS CHANDRA BOSE AND ELDER BROTHER SARAT CHANDRA BOSE, AS PART OF THE PROVINCIAL BENGAL CONGRESS HAD BEEN GRADUALLY WORKING TOWARDS THE CREATION OF AN ALLIANCE WITH THE KPP AND OTHER PROGRESSIVE ORGANIZATIONS IN BENGAL IN THE 1930S – TO RESOLVE BENGALI ISSUES WITH BENGALI SOLUTIONS
- SUBHAS CHANDRA BOSE FACES NOT JUST THE PRINCIPAL ENEMY, THE *RAJ* BUT DOMESTIC ENEMIES INCLUDING THE BUSINESS ELITES WHO WISH FOR AN ACCOMMODATION WITH THE *RAJ*

UNDER THE FRAMEWORK OF THE 1935 ACT, TWO YEARS LATER ELECTIONS ARE HELD FOR THE COLONIAL PROVINCIAL ASSEMBLIES

From the failure of Satyagraha-Khilafat to the start of the Second World War

- WHILE CONGRESS WINS IN A MAJORITY OF THE PROVINCES (8/11) THERE IS A PROBLEM; IT HAS FAILED TO WIN MUSLIM SUPPORT, BEING UNABLE TO FIELD MUSLIM CANDIDATES IN MANY SEATS
- CONGRESS ALSO BACKTRACKS ON A PRE-ELECTION PROMISE TO GO INTO COALITION WITH THE LEAGUE
- IN BENGAL, INSTEAD OF ALLOWING THE LOCAL CONGRESS TO GO INTO COALITION WITH THE KPP, GANDHI – AT THE BEHEST OF HIS COMMUNAL FINANCIAL BACKERS – REJECTS IT, THUS PAVING THE WAY FOR THE KPP'S FATEFUL COALITION WITH THE LEAGUE
- THE LEAGUE, PREVIOUSLY UNABLE TO CONNECT WITH BENGALI MUSLIM PEASANTS NOW IS ABLE TO DO SO THROUGH THE KPP

From the failure of Satyagraha-Khilafat to the start of the Second World War

- IN 1939 SUBHAS CHANDRA BOSE WON RE-ELECTION TO THE ANNUAL POSITION OF CONGRESS PRESIDENT – AGAINST GANDHI'S OPEN OPPOSITION
- THE *RAJ* NOTED THAT GANDHI AND HIS FOLLOWERS HAD FREELY BRIBED CONGRESS DELEGATES TO VOTE AGAINST SUBHAS CHANDRA BOSE
- THIS ILLUSTRATED THAT POPULAR SENTIMENT WAS BEHIND A MORE DYNAMIC AND MILITANT APPROACH TO THE ANTI-COLONIAL STRUGGLE
- HOWEVER, THROUGH A SERIES OF UNDEMOCRATIC MANEUVERS – INCLUDING MISTAKES MADE BY SUBHAS CHANDRA BOSE – GANDHI FORCED THE DEFEAT OF HIS ARCH BENGALI RIVAL

From the failure of Satyagraha-Khilafat to the start of the Second World War

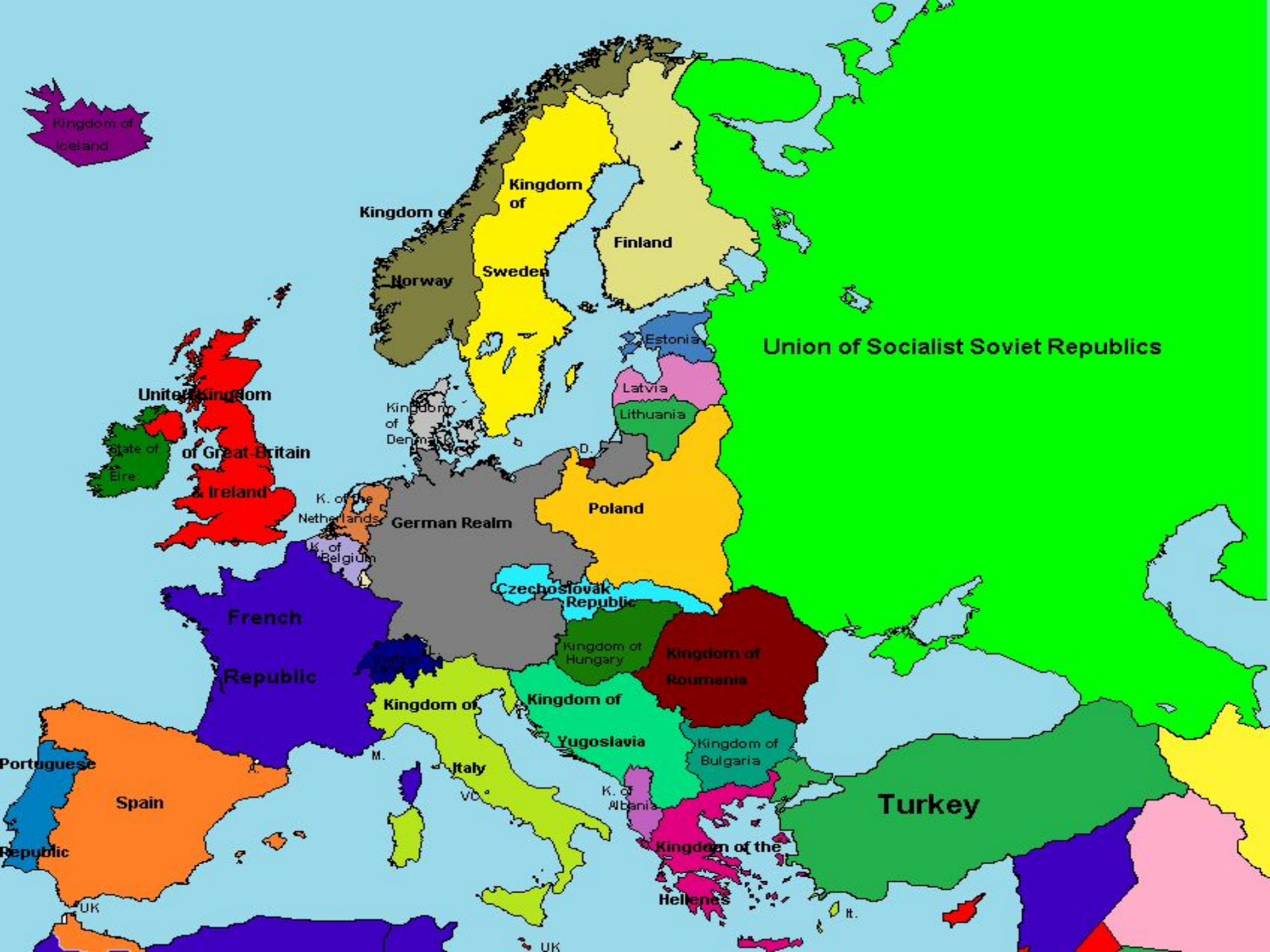
- BETWEEN 1939 – 1940, NOT CONTENT WITH THE DEFEAT OF SUBHAS CHANDRA BOSE, GANDHI HAD HIM AND HIS SUPPORTERS EXPELLED FROM THE ORGANIZATION – A PROCESS THAT CONTINUED INTO 1945

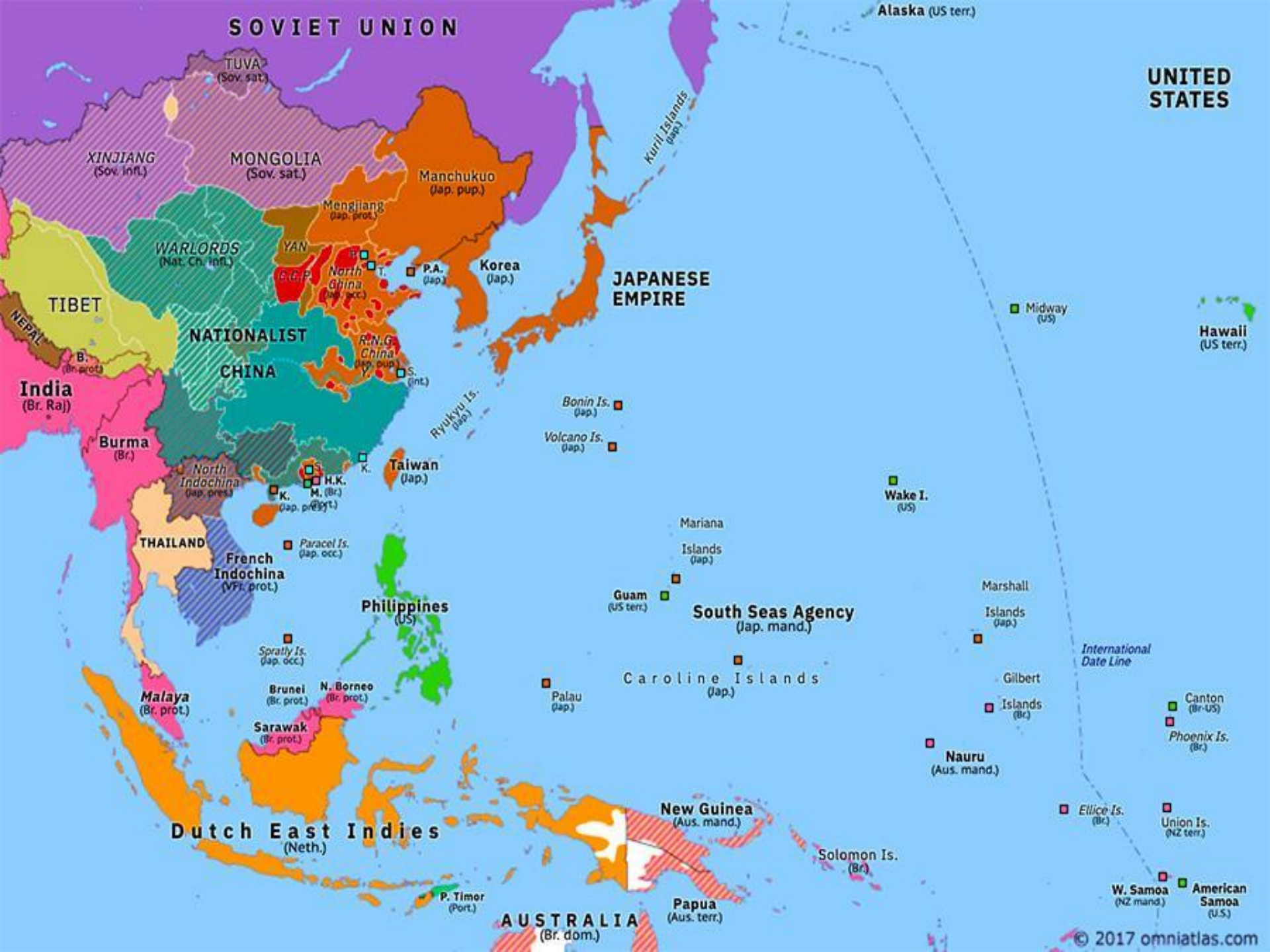
- THUS, THE BENGAL CONGRESS IN THE LEAD UP TO 1946-1947 WAS AN ENTIRELY *COMMUNAL ENTITY*

- SUBHAS CHANDRA BOSE HAD WANTED TO REMAIN AS THE HEAD OF THE LARGEST POLITICAL ORGANIZATION AS THE SECOND WORLD WAR WAS ABOUT TO BREAK OUT IN SEPTEMBER 1939

From the start of the Second World War to Dominion Status in August 1947

- ON SEPTEMBER 1ST, 1939 GERMANY INVADED POLAND
- ON SEPTEMBER 3RD, 1939, JOHN HOPE, THE IMPERIAL VICEROY – WITHOUT CONSULTING A SINGLE INDIAN, NOT EVEN COLLABORATORS AND THUS SHOWING THAT THE 1935 ACT OF 'DEVOLUTION' OF POWER, HAD BEEN A SHAM – DECLARED THAT THE INDIAN SUBCONTINENT ON BEHALF OF THE BRITISH EMPIRE WAS AT WAR WITH GERMANY
- THE BRITISH INTEND TO USE THE SUBCONTINENT AS AN INDUSTRIAL PLANT AND SUPPLY CENTRE DURING ITS WAR AGAINST ITS ENEMIES
- THE LEAGUE AND THE COMMUNAL PARTIES IMMEDIATELY AND OPENLY PLEDGE THEIR COLLABORATION TO THE *RAJ*


Kingdom of Iceland
Kingdom of Norway
Kingdom of Sweden
Finland
Union of Socialist Soviet Republics
Estonia
Latvia
Lithuania
United Kingdom of Great-Britain & Ireland
State of Eire
Kingdom of Denmark
D.
Poland
K. of the Netherlands
German Realm
K. of Belgium
Czechoslovak Republic
French Republic
Kingdom of Hungary
Kingdom of Roumania
Kingdom of Italy
Kingdom of Yugoslavia
Kingdom of Bulgaria
Turkey
K. of Albania
Kingdom of the Hellenes
Portuguese Republic
Spain
UK
It.


SOVIET UNION
TUVA
(Sov. sat.)
XINJIANG
(Sov. infl.)
MONGOLIA
(Sov. sat.)
Manchukuo
(Jap. pup.)
Mengjiang
(Jap. prot.)
WARLORDS
(Nat. Ch. infl.)
YAN
G.G.P.
North China
(Jap. occ.)
P.A.
(Jap.)
Korea
(Jap.)
JAPANESE EMPIRE
TIBET
NEPAL
B.
(Br. prot.)
NATIONALIST CHINA
R.N.G. China
(Jap. pup.)
S.
(Int.)
India
(Br. Raj)
Burma
(Br.)
North Indochina
(Jap. pres.)
H.K.
M. (Br.)
(Port.)
K.
(Jap. pres.)
Taiwan
(Jap.)
Ryukyu Is.
(Jap.)
Bonin Is.
(Jap.)
Volcano Is.
(Jap.)
THAILAND
French Indochina
(Vfr. prot.)
Paracel Is.
(Jap. occ.)
Philippines
(US)
Spratly Is.
(Jap. occ.)
Brunei
(Br. prot.)
N. Borneo
(Br. prot.)
Malaya
(Br. prot.)
Sarawak
(Br. prot.)
Dutch East Indies
(Neth.)
P. Timor
(Port.)
AUSTRALIA
(Br. dom.)
Kuril Islands
(Jap.)
Alaska (US terr.)
UNITED STATES
Midway
(US)
Hawaii
(US terr.)
Wake I.
(US)
Mariana Islands
(Jap.)
Guam
(US terr.)
South Seas Agency
(Jap. mand.)
Caroline Islands
(Jap.)
Palau
(Jap.)
Marshall Islands
(Jap.)
International Date Line
Gilbert Islands
(Br.)
Canton
(Br-US)
Phoenix Is.
(Br.)
Nauru
(Aus. mand.)
Ellice Is.
(Br.)
Union Is.
(NZ terr.)
New Guinea
(Aus. mand.)
Solomon Is.
(Br.)
Papua
(Aus. terr.)
W. Samoa
(NZ mand.)
American Samoa
(U.S.)
© 2017 omniatlas.com

From the start of the Second World War to Dominion Status in August 1947

- GANDHI AND CONGRESS INITIALLY WANT TO PLEDGE THEIR SUPPORT TO THE *RAJ* BUT BACKTRACK WHEN THEY REALIZE THAT PUBLIC OPINION IS AGAINST PARTICIPATION
- SUBHAS CHANDRA BOSE, WHO HAS NOW FORMED HIS OWN PARTY, THE *FORWARD BLOC*, IS CLEAR ABOUT WHAT THE WAR MEANS – AN OPPORTUNITY FOR THE SUBCONTINENT TO STRIKE FOR HER FREEDOM
- IN 1940 SUBHAS CHANDRA BOSE FINALIZES A PLAN TO ESCAPE FROM THE SUBCONTINENT – AND JOIN HANDS WITH THE ENEMIES OF THE *RAJ* AND ORGANIZE A MOVEMENT FROM ABROAD



From the start of the Second World War to Dominion Status in August 1947

- **IN BENGAL DURING 1941 – 1943 THE KPP, THE *FORWARD BLOC* AND THE MAHASABHA FORM A UNIQUE COALITION COLONIAL LEGISLATIVE ADMINISTRATION**

- **IN THE END THE *RAJ* AND THE LEAGUE TRICK FAZLUL HUQ INTO ITS DISSOLUTION**

- **WHILE IT DID NOT HAVE ANY POWERS OF CONSEQUENCE – HOW SUCH A COALITION MIGHT HAVE HANDLED THE EVENTS OF 1946-1947 REMAINS A THOUGHTFUL QUESTION**

From the start of the Second World War to Dominion Status in August 1947

- **THE BENGAL FAMINE OF 1943**
- **AS WITH OTHER BRITISH ENGINEERED FAMINES; THE ISSUE WAS NOT ONE OF THE *AVAILABILITY* OF FOOD – BUT *ACCESS* TO IT**
- **THE *RAJ* HAD TAKEN A DELIBERATE DECISION THAT FOOD WOULD ONLY BE GIVEN TO THOSE SECTIONS OF THE POPULACE WHO WERE OF 'USE' TO THEIR WAR EFFORT**
- **BETWEEN 3 – 5 MILLION INNOCENT BENGALIS PERISH AS A RESULT**

From the start of the Second World War to Dominion Status in August 1947

- **MARCH 1940: THE LAHORE RESOLUTION IS ANNOUNCED – NO REFERENCE TO AN ENTITY CALLED 'PAKISTAN' – BUT THE CALL IS MADE TO THE *RAJ* TO MAKE PROVISIONS FOR MUSLIM-MAJORITY PROVINCES IN THE EVENT OF A BRITISH DEPARTURE FROM THE SUBCONTINENT**

- **UNTIL 1943 MOHAMMAD ALI JINNAH, THE PRINCIPAL LEADER OF THE LEAGUE, REFUSES TO ENTERTAIN THE TERM 'PAKISTAN'**

- **IN 1946 JINNAH REMOVES THE REFERENCE TO 'PROVINCES' OR 'STATES' AND MAKES IT A SINGULAR STATE**

From the start of the Second World War to Dominion Status in August 1947

- IN JANUARY 1941 SUBHAS CHANDRA BOSE DRAMATICALLY ESCAPES THE BRITISH OCCUPIED SUBCONTINENT – IN APRIL HE REACHES BERLIN, THE CAPITAL OF NATIONAL-SOCIALIST GERMANY
  - SUBHAS CHANDRA BOSE'S SIGNAL IMPORTANCE IS UNDERLINED BY THE FACT THAT HE WAS OFFICIALLY TARGETED FOR ASSASSINATION BY THE BRITISH GOVERNMENT AFTER JANUARY 1941 – WITH SUCH INSTRUCTIONS GIVEN TO ALL BRITISH FORCES
- FROM CAPTURED MERCENARIES AND CIVILIANS, HE FORMS THE FREE INDIA LEGION – FOR THE FIRST TIME SINCE 1857 A LEADER OF THE SUBCONTINENT HAS SUCCESSFULLY FORMED A MILITARY UNIT LOYAL TO THE PEOPLES OF THE SUBCONTINENT AND NOT THE *RAJ*
  - HOWEVER, HE IS FRUSTRATED IN NOT BEING ABLE TO PARTICIPATE IN THE MASS UPRISINGS THAT BREAKOUT AFTER AUGUST 1942 ACROSS THE SUBCONTINENT



From the start of the Second World War to Dominion Status in August 1947

- IN AUGUST 1942 UNDER TREMENDOUS PRESSURE FROM THE POPULACE, GANDHI ANNOUNCES THE 'QUIT INDIA MOVEMENT'
- THE *RAJ* ARRESTS GANDHI AND HIS ENTIRE LEADERSHIP – THUS THE MOVEMENT BECOMES A DECENTRALIZED ASSORTMENT OF SELF-PROPELLED ANTI-COLONIAL STRUGGLES
- FROM BERLIN, USING RADIO BROADCASTS SUBHAS CHANDRA BOSE URGES HIS FOLLOWERS AND REVOLUTIONARIES TO USE WHAT EVER METHODS AND TACTICS THEY CAN TO COMBAT THE *RAJ*
- THE BRITISH BRUTALLY CRUSH THE STRUGGLES BY AUGUST 1943; INCLUDING USING TORTURE AND RAPE AS WEAPONS OF WAR
- GANDHI WILL CATEGORICALLY REJECT ANY ASSOCIATION WITH THE EVENTS OF THE QUIT INDIA MOVEMENT

(c)

PROVISIONAL GOVERNMENT OF AZAD HIND FORMED.

The Provisional Government of Azad Hind has been formed in East Asia under my leadership.

I have organised this Government of Azad Hind in accordance with the unanimous will of three million free Indians in East Asia. This is the first free Government of India since the advent of British Imperialism.

The main task of the Provisional Government of Azad Hind is to liberate the Indian people from the shackles of Anglo-American domination. Government of Azad Hind will crush the Anglo-American forces of aggression in India and establish an India of the Indians.

Comrades of the Indian Army! The Azad Hind Fauj—the Army of Free India—under my command, is already on the move. That powerful army of Free Indians in East Asia will soon begin its march to Delhi—the citadel of British power in India. Be prepared to join the Azad Hind Fauj and to play your valiant part in India's War of Independence.

Compatriots in India! Very soon, the British and the Americans will be forced out of India; and the Government of Azad Hind will be established on Indian soil. The Government of Azad Hind by the Indians, for the Indians. Support the Government of Azad Hind which is *Your* Government and help the expulsion of the Anglo-American enemies from India.

JAI HIND

Subhas Chandra Bose

29


www.columbia.edu


अंग्रेजों के तालु पर नाचना छोड़ दो और
धार्मिक विभिन्नता को मुल कस्स्वाधीनता के लिये एकत्र हो।
ইংরেজের তলে আর তাল দিওনা ধর্ম্ম
বিভেদ ভুলিয়া গিয়া স্বাধীনতার জন্য একত্রবদ্ধ হও
ভারতবর্ষ

A unique feature of the 'Free India Army' or 'Azad Hind Fauj' in East Asia was the formation of a fully-trained and armed women's only regiment of freedom fighters.

Subhas Chandra Bose chose Lakshmi Swaminathan, a brilliant young doctor in Singapore, to organize and head the unit.

The regiment saw heavy combat during the retreat from Burma in 1944-45.



Lakshmi Swaminathan Commandant of the *Rani Jhansi* Regiment

From the start of the Second World War to Dominion Status in August 1947

- IN 1943 SUBHAS CHANDRA BOSE ARRIVED IN EAST ASIA AND ESTABLISHED A PROVISIONAL GOVERNMENT OF FREE INDIA AND A LARGER ARMY OF LIBERATION – THE INDIAN NATIONAL ARMY; COMPOSED OF CIVILIANS FROM THE SUBCONTINENT BASED IN EAST ASIA AND MERCENARIES WHO HAD BEEN CAPTURED BY THE JAPANESE

- DURING 1943-1944 THE INDIAN NATIONAL ARMY TOOK PART IN THE IMPHAL-KOHIMA CAMPAIGN
- ON 18 AUGUST 1945; WHILE TRAVELING ONWARDS TO MEET WITH SOVIET OFFICIALS, THE PLANE CARRYING SUBHAS CHANDRA BOSE CRASHED IN TAIPEI
- SUBHAS CHANDRA BOSE DIES LATER THAT EVENING FROM BURN WOUNDS – THE ONLY MAJOR SUBCONTINENTAL LEADER TO DIE ON THE BATTLEFIELD

From the start of the Second World War to Dominion Status in August 1947

- AT THE END OF THE WAR, THE *RAJ* FOOLISHLY DECIDES TO PUT OFFICERS AND SOLDIERS OF THE INA ON TRIAL FOR "TREASON"
- THIS LEADS TO A MASSIVE SUBCONTINENT WIDE GROUNDSWELL OF AGITATION AND ANGER – AND SEVERELY UNDERMINES THE LOYALTY OF THE MERCENARIES TO THEIR BRITISH MASTERS

- IN EARLY 1946 AN UPRISING TAKES PLACE ONBOARD THE SHIPS OF THE MERCENARY NAVY – THE SO-CALLED 'ROYAL INDIAN NAVY'; WITH TENS OF THOUSANDS OF SAILORS PARTICIPATING IN PORTS ACROSS THE SUBCONTINENT
- SAILORS AND CIVILIANS – HINDUS AND MUSLIMS FIGHT SIDE-BY-SIDE AGAINST BRITISH AND MERCENARY FORCES

From the start of the Second World War to Dominion Status in August 1947

- BRITISH MILITARY AND CIVILIAN OFFICIALS CONCLUDE THAT TO REASSERT COMPLETE CONTROL OF THE SUBCONTINENT WOULD REQUIRE A 'RECONQUEST' – THIS WAS NO LONGER POSSIBLE IN THE AFTERMATH OF THE WAR WITH BRITAIN FINANCIALLY AND MILITARILY EXHAUSTED AND REMAINING RESOURCES NEEDED ELSEWHERE TO HOLD ON TO OTHER SECTORS OF THE EMPIRE
- THE LACK OF COMPLETE TRUST IN THEIR MERCENARIES AFTER THE EVENTS OF THE INA OFFICERS TRIALS AND THE RIN UPRISING WAS ENTIRELY DUE TO THE ACTIONS OF SUBHAS CHANDRA BOSE AND THE INDIAN NATIONAL ARMY
- A DECISION IS TAKEN BY LONDON TO DEPART FROM THE *RAJ* BY HOPING TO TRANSFER POWER TO ITS PREFERRED COLLABORATORS IN THE CONGRESS AND THE LEAGUE

From the start of the Second World War to Dominion Status in August 1947

- A BRITISH CABINET MISSION IS SENT IN EARLY 1946 TO PROPOSE A FEDERAL SCHEME FOR THE PROVINCES OF THE SUBCONTINENT WITH PROVISIONS FOR INDIVIDUAL PROVINCES TO 'OPT-OUT' IN FAVOUR OF INDEPENDENCE AFTER A PERIOD OF TEN YEARS

- AFTER AGREEING IN PRINCIPLE TO THE SCHEME; JAWAHARLAL NEHRU PUBLICLY REJECTED IT

- IN AUGUST 1946 JINNAH CALLED FOR A 'DAY OF DIRECT ACTION' IN RESPONSE

- THIS CULMINATED IN THE COMMUNAL RIOTS OF CALCUTTA DURING AUGUST 16–19

From the start of the Second World War to Dominion Status in August 1947

- FEBRUARY 1947: LONDON SENDS LOUIS MOUNTBATTEN AS THE LAST IMPERIAL VICEROY WITH A MANDATE TO DEPART BY JUNE 1948
- THE EMPIRE WAS ALREADY RENAMED THE 'COMMONWEALTH' AND LONDON DEMANDED THAT INDEPENDENCE MUST BE PRECEDED BY 'DOMINION STATUS' (A COLONY ENJOYING GREATER POWERS OF SELF-GOVERNANCE)
- THE BRITISH RELATIONSHIP WITH HINDUS AND MUSLIMS NOW WENT THROUGH A FULL CIRCLE SINCE 1757 – FRIENDSHIP WITH HINDUS AND ENMITY TOWARDS MUSLIMS UP TO THE LATE 19TH CENTURY; FOLLOWED BY FRIENDSHIP WITH MUSLIMS AND ENMITY TOWARDS HINDUS – BUT NOW A DECISION WAS TAKEN TO FAVOUR THE 'HINDU' CONGRESS AT THE EXPENSE OF THE LEAGUE

From the start of the Second World War to Dominion Status in August 1947

- JUNE 1947: MOUNTBATTEN ANNOUNCES THAT THE *RAJ* WILL DEPART ON AUGUST 14
- POPULAR WISHES WOULD BE IGNORED; THE EXISTING COLONIAL ASSEMBLIES WOULD MAKE THE CHOICE BETWEEN A DOMINION INDIA OR DOMINION PAKISTAN
- IN BENGAL AND THE PUNJAB THE ONLY CHOICE WOULD BE TO DIVIDE THE PROVINCE
- THE NORTH-WEST FRONTIER PROVINCE – OVERWHELMINGLY MUSLIM – HAD SUPPORTED CONGRESS AND OPPOSED PARTITION; YET NOW AT THE LAST MOMENT IT WAS ABANDONED BY CONGRESS, COUNTERING THE CLAIM OF CONGRESS TO SECULARISM

From the start of the Second World War to Dominion Status in August 1947

- IN BENGAL; A PROPOSAL IS PUT FORWARD BY SARAT CHANDRA BOSE AND H.S. SUHRAWARDY FOR A THIRD INDEPENDENT ENTITY – BUT THIS IS OPPOSED BY NEHRU, GANDHI, THE CONGRESS JOINING WITH THE HINDU MAHASABHA IN SUPPORT OF PARTITION, AND ULTIMATELY THE *RAJ*
- ONE FEAR WAS THAT IF A UNITED BENGAL WAS MADE A VIABLE OPTION THEN THE PROVINCES OF THE SOUTHERN PART OF THE SUBCONTINENT, WITH CHRISTIANS AND STRONG ANTI-BRAHMANICAL TRADITIONS IN PLACES SUCH AS TAMIL NADU WOULD HAVE ALSO OPTED TO LEAVE
- IN THE BENGAL COLONIAL ASSEMBLY, THE VOTE WAS 126 TO 90 IN FAVOUR OF A UNITED BENGAL; BUT FORCED TO VOTE SEPARATELY ON THE QUESTION OF PARTITION, HINDUS AND MUSLIMS VOTED ALONG RELIGIOUS LINES

From the start of the Second World War to Dominion Status in August 1947

- THE REFUSAL OF THE *RAJ* OVERSEE AN ORDERLY PARTITION – ESTIMATED AT OVER ONE YEAR AND NOT LESS THAN SIX WEEKS – UNLEASHED UNIMAGINABLE BRUTALITY AND HORROR IN FRATRICIDAL KILLINGS IN THE NORTHERN PORTION OF THE SUBCONTINENT AND THE PUNJAB
- ANYWHERE OVER 4 MILLION HINDUS AND SIKHS WERE FORCED TO ESCAPE TO EAST PUNJAB AND OVER 5 MILLION MUSLIMS WERE EXPELLED TO WEST PUNJAB
- OVER 12 MILLION PEOPLE WERE FORCED TO LEAVE THEIR HOMES AS REFUGEES AND ESCAPE
- COUNTLESS THOUSANDS OF WOMEN AND GIRLS FROM ALL THREE RELIGIOUS COMMUNITIES WERE KIDNAPPED AND DISAPPEARED
- THE TOTAL NUMBER OF PEOPLE KILLED DURING THE PARTITION VARY – BUT MINIMUM ESTIMATES ARE OVER 1 MILLION

From the start of the Second World War to Dominion Status in August 1947

- WHILE THERE WERE SOME COMMUNAL RIOTS IN BENGAL – CALCUTTA AND NOAKHALI – THEY WERE NOTHING ON THE SCALE OR BRUTALITY WITNESSED IN THE PUNJAB

- THERE WERE ALSO NOTABLE EXAMPLES OF NON-COMMUNAL MOVEMENTS – SUCH AS THE 'ONE-THIRD SHARE' OR 'TEBHAGA' CAMPAIGN – UNITING HINDU AND MUSLIM FARMERS LED BY ACTIVISTS SUCH AS ILA MITRA
- AN ADDITIONAL REASON FOR THE HATRED DIRECTED TOWARDS EAST BENGALIS BY THE WEST PAKISTAN PUNJAB ELITES – AFTER AUGUST 1947 WAS THE REFUSAL OF EAST BENGALIS TO BLINDLY EXHIBIT HATRED OF INDIA AND INDIANS (POST AUGUST 1947) – DUE TO THE HORRIFIC EXPERIENCES OF THE FRATRICIDAL GENOCIDE THAT TOOK PLACE IN THE PUNJAB DURING PARTITION

From the start of the Second World War to Dominion Status in August 1947

- THE BRITISH EMPIRE ALSO TREACHEROUSLY – BUT NOT UNEXPECTEDLY – ABANDONS THE SO-CALLED PRINCELY STATES, THE ROYAL COLLABORATORS AFTER 1857, TO THEIR FATES PRIMARILY TO DOMINION INDIA
  - IN THE END; INDIA AND PAKISTAN DO NOT BECOME INDEPENDENT ON 14/15 AUGUST 1947 BUT DOMINION STATES UNTIL THEY PROMULGATE THEIR OWN CONSTITUTIONS
- THE ECONOMIC, POLITICAL, BUREAUCRATIC AND MILITARY SYSTEMS OF BOTH REMAIN TIED TO THE COLONIAL MASTER – IN THE CASE OF DOMINION PAKISTAN, JINNAH QUICKLY MOVES CLOSER TO THE NEW PARAMOUNT WORLD POWER AND SUCCESSOR TO THE *RAJ* IN THE WORLD-SYSTEM – THE UNITED STATES OF AMERICA, WITH ALL ITS IMPLICATIONS

Readings from *Land of Two Rivers* by Nitish Sengupta

- 1. OVER A DECADE OF HINDU-MUSLIM CAMARADERIE, PP. 330 – 348.
- 2. UNMAKING OF A NATION, PP. 367 – 388.
- 3. THE LAST HOUR OF UNITED BENGAL, PP. 450 – 487.
- 4. SECOND PARTITION OF BENGAL, PP. 486 – 496.